

THE RESET METHOD

MASTER RECOVERY.
TRANSFORM HABITS.
ACHIEVE BALANCE.

R O H A N G U P T A

INDEX

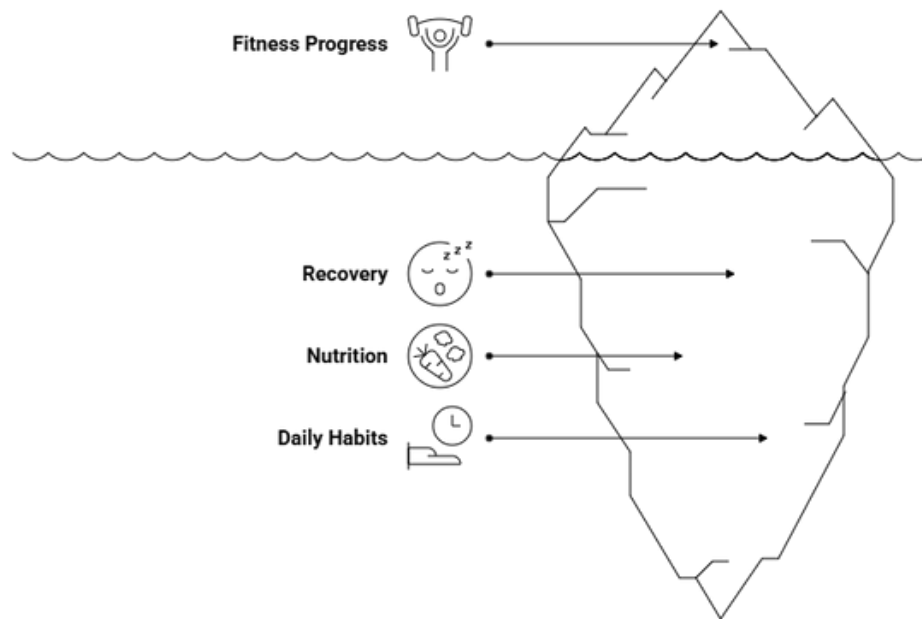
Chapter / Topic	Page No.
Recovery & Daily Habits – Introduction	1
Core Recovery Pillars	2–4
Eye-Opening Tips & Daily Habit System	5
Male-Specific Recovery & Habits + Daily Checklist	6
Female-Specific Recovery & Habits	7
Female Practical Checklist	8
Goal-Specific Summary	9
2-Week Habit Starter	10

SECTION 3: RECOVERY & DAILY HABITS

Recovery & Daily Habits:

Recovery and everyday habits are the underrated, behind-the-scenes engines that decide whether months of training and disciplined eating actually translate into the physique you want. Below is a full, easy-to-follow, evidence-informed guide that you can drop into your eBook. It's split into general principles and sex-specific sections (male / female), includes clear actions for fat loss, bulking and muscle growth, and lots of “wake-up” tips that change how people think about progress.

Quick overview



- Training creates stimulus; recovery and nutrition decide whether that stimulus becomes muscle, strength or lost fat.
- If sleep, stress and daily movement are poor, progress stalls even if the workout and diet look “perfect.”
- Small daily habits (sleep time, steps, meal protein distribution) compound into huge results over weeks.

Core recovery pillars

(the fundamentals every reader must follow)



1. Sleep (the single most powerful recovery tool)

- **Target:** 7–9 hours nightly for most adults. Consistency matters more than a few late nights.
- **Practical routine:** Same wake time every day → 90–120 minutes before bed stop screens or use blue-light filters → light stretching / reading → lights out.
- **Why it matters:** Sleep regulates hunger and satiety hormones, testosterone and growth hormone release, cognitive focus, training performance and recovery. Poor sleep increases cravings and reduces ability to build/retain muscle during dieting.

2. Movement outside the gym (NEAT)

1. Target steps: 8–10k/day is a good general range; aim to increase baseline NEAT if sedentary.
2. How to add it: Walk after meals, stand while on calls, short walks between study/work blocks.
3. Why it matters: Extra daily calories burned through NEAT are huge for fat loss and energy balance and don't tax recovery like extra cardio often does.

3. Hydration

1. Targets: Men $\approx$ 3–4 L/day; Women $\approx$ 2–3 L/day (individual needs vary with climate, training, sweat).
2. Practical: Drink regularly, include water first thing, carry a bottle, don't wait until very thirsty. Add electrolytes on hot/delayed sweat days.
3. Why it matters: Hydration affects digestion, energy, training performance, recovery and perceived hunger.

4. Protein & meal spacing

1. Daily protein targets (general):
 - a. Fat loss (retain muscle): 1.8–2.4 g/kg bodyweight/day
 - b. Bulking/growth: 1.6–2.2 g/kg/day
 - c. Recomposition/maintenance: 1.6–2.0 g/kg/day
2. Per-meal: Aim for $\sim$ 25–40 g of high-quality protein every 3–4 hours to maximize muscle protein synthesis.
3. Why: Protein is the building block for muscle + keeps you fuller during deficits.

5. Calories & macro rules of thumb

1. Fat loss: Moderate deficit $\sim$ 300–500 kcal/day (or 10–20% below maintenance). Bigger deficits lose weight faster but risk muscle loss and recovery problems.
2. Bulking: Small surplus $\sim$ 200–500 kcal/day (5–15% above maintenance) to maximize muscle gain and minimize fat gain.
3. Carbs & fats: Prioritize carbs around training for performance; keep fats at 20–35% of calories to support hormones. Females often do better with the middle-to-higher end of that fat range for hormonal health (see female section).

6. Stress management & mental recovery

- Daily stress drives cortisol (which can hinder fat loss and recovery). Use simple tools: breathing, 10-20 minute low-pressure walks, journaling, short meditation, social time.
- Habit tip: schedule a daily “reset” - 10 minutes of low-intensity movement or breath work after work to separate “work stress” from “training/recovery time.”

7. Smart training recovery (deloads & progression)

1. Deloads: Every 4–8 weeks do a lighter week (volume down by 30–50% or intensity down). Prevents overtraining and plateaus.
2. Progressive overload: Track key lifts; aim to slowly increase sets/reps/weights over weeks. If strength stalls for 2–3 weeks and sleep/diet are fine, reduce training stress briefly then restart progression.

8. Mobility, soft tissue & active recovery

1. Short daily mobility (5–10 minutes) and weekly foam rolling/soft tissue work can improve movement quality and reduce injury risk.
2. Active recovery days (walking, mobility, light cycling) help blood flow without stressing recovery.

9. Supplements: what helps (but is optional)

1. Creatine monohydrate: 3–5 g/day supports strength and muscle growth.
2. Protein powder: Useful for hitting protein targets.
3. Vitamin D: If levels are low (check bloodwork).
4. Omega-3 (EPA/DHA): 1–2 g/day for inflammation and general health.
5. Caffeine: Effective pre-workout performance boost (use carefully).
6. Females: check iron status routinely; supplement if deficient (with medical advice).
7. NOTE: Supplements aren’t replacements for food/calories and a sound plan.

Eye-opening tips: things that change outcomes quickly

1. Tiny NEAT wins beat extra cardio: An extra 1,000 purposeful steps daily can burn more energy across weeks than a single extra 40-minute cardio session with less recovery cost.
2. Protein distribution matters: Hitting protein evenly across meals preserves muscle better during cuts than dumping protein in one meal.
3. Sleep loss is caloric poison: Even one week of poor sleep increases hunger and sugar cravings that can undo a diet. Prioritize sleep before “adding cardio.”
4. Refeeds are not “cheating” they help: Short high-carb refeeds can restore training intensity and hormone balance during longer deficits.
5. Consistency > perfection: 90% adherence for months wins far more than 100% for 2 weeks then quitting.

Daily habit-building system (how to make these stick)

1. Start tiny: pick one habit for 2 weeks (e.g., go to bed 15 minutes earlier).
2. Stack habits: after brushing teeth, do 2 minutes of mobility linking to an existing habit helps adoption.
3. Environment design: keep water visible, protein sources portioned, remove late-night snack triggers.
4. Implementation intention: “If X happens, I will do Y.” Example: “If I feel hungry late, I will drink water and wait 20 minutes.”
5. Accountability: weekly check-ins with a coach, friend, or simple habit app.
6. Reward & celebrate: small wins build momentum (celebrate extra sleep nights or a week of consistent protein).

Male-specific section

Key physiology notes

- Males generally have higher baseline testosterone which helps build muscle faster when training and eating properly, but testosterone is still sensitive to sleep, body fat, alcohol and stress.
- Fat loss for men often shows first around the midsection but individual patterns vary.

Practical male-focused recovery & habit strategies

- Sleep & testosterone: prioritize 7–9 hours; poor sleep reduces testosterone and impairs strength gains.
- Alcohol: keep to minimal amounts when trying to build muscle or maintain low body fat alcohol reduces recovery and hormonal status.
- Strength focus: emphasize compound lifts (squat, deadlift, bench, press, row) 2–4x/week depending on program. Heavy and progressive loading gives the best muscle & strength returns.
- Cardio vs NEAT: keep moderate cardio but prioritize NEAT for fat loss to avoid interfering with muscle recovery from lifting.
- Protein target: follow the general protein ranges above (aim upper range during cuts: 1.8–2.4 g/kg).
- Supplements priority: creatine is a top priority; consider fish oil and vitamin D.

Sample daily check-list for a male trainee

- 7–9 hr sleep (fixed wake time)
- 8–10k steps total
- Training session with progressive overload recorded
- Protein target met in 3–5 meals (25–40 g each)
- Hydration goal met (3–4 L)
- 10–15 min mobility or foam roll
- One planned refeed a week (if in deficit)

Female-specific section

Key physiology notes

- Females have different hormonal cycles (menstrual cycle) that affect energy, appetite, and strength across the month. This is normal not a weakness.
- Very aggressive calorie deficits and very low body fat can disrupt menstrual function (amenorrhea) and long-term bone health.

Cycle-aware training (practical and simple)

- Track the cycle (app or diary) for 2–3 months to see patterns.
 - Follicular phase (start of bleed → ovulation): energy and strength often higher plan heavier, higher-volume training here if possible.
 - Luteal phase (post-ovulation → before bleed): appetite and body temp often increase; volume or intensity can be reduced slightly and still be effective. Focus on high-quality protein and recovery.
- Adjust calories slightly (+100–200 kcal) in luteal phase if hunger is higher; this prevents binges and keeps training quality up. Small, planned increases beat uncontrolled overeating.

Recovery & hormonal health priorities

- Don't chase extreme deficits. Aim for 10–20% deficit for fat loss; very fast losses risk menstrual irregularities and losing lean mass.
- Fats for hormones: aim for dietary fat toward the mid-range (25–35% of calories) and include omega-3 sources.
- Iron & vitamin D: females have higher risk of iron deficiency check bloodwork and supplement if needed. Vitamin D supports energy and immunity.
- Strength training: prioritize compound lifts 2–4 times per week women respond very well to strength work and it's crucial for shaping and metabolic health.

Female practical checklist

- Track cycle for 2–3 months and note training energy and cravings.
- Keep protein consistent across day prioritize protein even during perimenstrual days to preserve muscle.
- Hydration 2–3 L/day and include electrolytes during heavy training or heat.
- Plan refeeds or small calorie increases during luteal if needed to stabilize mood/energy.
- Regular bone health support: resistance training + adequate calcium and vitamin D.

Goal-specific summary (one-page cheat-sheet)

For fat loss

1. Calories: -300 to -500 kcal/day (10–20% deficit).
2. Protein: 1.8–2.4 g/kg (higher end to preserve muscle).
3. Training: resistance 3–5x/week + NEAT 8–10k steps.
4. Recovery: 7–9 h sleep, weekly deloads if training volume high.
5. Monitor: weekly weight + photos + strength. Refeed 1x/week if aggressive.

For bulking / muscle growth

6. Calories: +200 to +500 kcal/day (small surplus).
7. Protein: 1.6–2.2 g/kg.
8. Training: 3–6x/week with progressive overload, compound focus.
9. Recovery: prioritize sleep; deload every 4–8 weeks.
10. Monitor: monthly photos + strength increments; adjust calories if fat gain too fast.

For recomposition (gain muscle + lose fat)

11. Calories: near maintenance or slight deficit/surplus cycling.
12. Protein: 1.8–2.2 g/kg.
13. Training: consistent progressive resistance training 3–5x/week.
14. Recovery: strict sleep and NEAT they make recomposition possible.

2-week habit starter

Week 1:

- Bed by 11:00 pm, wake same time every day.
- +2,000 steps/day above baseline.
- Hit protein target each day.

Week 2:

- Add 5 minutes mobility after workout.
- Replace 2 sugary drinks with water.
- Record training weights and sleep hours daily.